- ACE — User Guide
  - 1. Quick start
  - 2. The dashboard at a glance
  - 3. Importing content
  - 4. Themes and Looks
  - 5. Outputs (Screen Configuration)
  - 6. Detection (lyric + Bible)
  - 7. Stage Layouts
  - 8. Service Plan
  - 9. Quick Screens (⌘J)
  - 10. Settings highlights
  - 11. Keyboard shortcuts (full reference)
  - 12. Common workflows
  - 13. Troubleshooting
  - 14. Where things live
  - 15. Getting help
  - 16. Glossary
  - 17. Feature Index — every panel, every button
  - 18. Complete Settings Reference
  - 19. API Endpoints (selected — for power users)

ACE — User Guide

Version: v1.6.1 · **Updated:** 2026-05-10

ACE (Agentic Cue Experience) is an AI-powered live presentation app for worship, conferences, lectures, and theater. It listens to what's happening in the room and pushes the right slide automatically — no manual clicking through cues during the service.

Tagline: **"Ace every cue."**

This guide is the comprehensive reference. For a 60-second walkthrough, use the in-app tour (runs once after first launch; re-trigger from Settings → General → "Show tour again"). For a quick visual map of every function, jump to **§17 Feature Index (every panel + button)** and **§18 Complete Settings Reference**.

---

1. Quick start

1. **Install** — drag `ACE.app` from the DMG into `/Applications`. First launch may take 10–30 seconds while the bundled AI model warms up.
2. **Animated welcome splash** *(v1.6)* — plays for ~15 seconds on first launch, or click anywhere to skip. Honours `prefers-reduced-motion` if you have macOS reduce-motion on.
3. **Onboarding wizard** *(5 steps)* — Welcome → Backend ready → Speech model download → macOS permissions (mic + screen-recording) → Done. If a ProPresenter library is detected on your Mac, the wizard auto-prompts the **ProPresenter Migrator** *(see §3)* before handing off to the dashboard.
4. **Click Start** (top-left of the toolbar) — ACE begins listening.
5. **Sing or speak** something the system knows. If you have a song library imported, ACE auto-pushes the matched lyrics. If not, see §3 (Importing content).
6. **To send to a real audience screen**, configure outputs via **⌘⇧S** (Screen Configuration) — see §5.

---

2. The dashboard at a glance

```
╔═══════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════╗
║  [Start] [Mode tabs] [Live/Hold] [Conf±]  │  [Show Edit Bible Theme  ║
║                                            │   Looks Stage Service]   ║
║                                            │   [Import]  [⚙ Settings] ║
║                                            │   [AudioVisualizer]      ║
╠═══════════════════════════════════════════╪═══════════════════════════╠
║  Sidebar: songs / presentations / Bible    │  Center: lyrics / slides ║
║                                            │                          ║
║                                            │  Right panel: Preview /  ║
║                                            │   Program / Macros /     ║
║                                            │   Sermon Notes           ║
╠═══════════════════════════════════════════╪═══════════════════════════╠
║  Bottom: Media Bin (playlists, backgrounds, foreground props)         ║
╚═══════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════╝
```

Toolbar — left side (detection controls)

- **Start / Stop** — toggles AI listening.
- **Mic-level visualizer** — traffic-light:
  - **Amber + slow pulse** → too quiet, speak louder or move closer
  - **Green** → good signal
  - **Red** → peaking, pull back or reduce input gain

- **Auto / Song / Bible** — detection mode. Auto detects either; Song-only locks to lyrics; Bible-only locks to scripture.
- **Live / Hold** — when Live, detected matches go straight to PROGRAM. Hold pauses auto-display (useful between songs).
- **Confidence ±** — tweak the AI threshold during a service.

Toolbar — center (workflow modes)

Tab	What it does
Show	Default live-service view. Detected lyrics + slides auto-push.
Edit	Modify song lyrics, sections.
Bible	Browse and display scripture.
Theme	Open the rich theme designer (canvas-based).
Looks *(v1.4)*	Combine themes + per-screen overrides + layer toggles into named presets.
Stage	Design the operator's confidence-monitor layout.
Service Plan	Plan the order of service (songs / Bible / prayer / sermon / announcements).

Toolbar — right side

- **Import** — unified wizard for Bibles, songs, and slides (PPTX / Keynote / PDF / image-sequence).
- ⚙ **Settings** — direct nav to Settings page *(added v1.4.1)*.
- **AudioVisualizer** — see Mic-level above.

Sidebar (left panel)

Library of imported content: songs, presentations (slide decks), Bibles. Drag-reorder to set the **Service Plan** (the day's order — songs and scripture in sequence).

Center column

- **Show mode** — current and next song lyric sections, scripture passages, slide thumbnails.
- **Edit mode** — full lyric/section editor.
- **Bible mode** — verse-context view.

Right panel

- **Preview / Program** — what's about to go live (Preview) and what is live (Program). Operators drive most of the service from here.
- **Macros** — operator-fired automations (clear all, switch look, etc.).
- **Sermon Notes** — sermon recording with auto-detected scripture references.

Media Bin (bottom dock)

Playlists, asset library, single-click trigger, layer/fit, Stock Bin filter (Pixabay if configured). Drag a media item onto the slide preview to make it the audience background.

---

3. Importing content

⌘I or click **Import** in the toolbar. Six-stage wizard:

Stage	What happens
Source	Drag-drop or pick files. Multi-format auto-detect.
Preview	Per-item preview (lyrics, scripture, slide titles). Bible references in PPTX titles + speaker notes are auto-detected and tagged per slide.
Resolve	Conflict detection — Skip / Replace / Continue per item.
Template *(v2)*	Apply a default theme to imported items.
Import	Runs ingestion.
Summary	Result counts + per-item status; reference grouping for Bible-detected items.

Supported formats

Type	Formats
Songs	Plain text, ChordPro / `.cho`, OpenLyrics XML, OpenSong XML, ProPresenter `.pro6` / `.pro7` / `.pro` *(v1.6 — newer PP7+ filename)*, OpenLP `.osz` *(9 formats)*
Bibles	MyBible `.SQLite3`, OSIS XML, Zefania XML, OpenSong XML *(4 formats)*
Slides	PowerPoint `.pptx`, Keynote `.key`, PDF, image-sequence (numbered PNG / JPEG / WebP / HEIC frames or a folder) *(4 sources)*

LibreOffice deferred-install

First PPTX import on a Mac without LibreOffice triggers an in-app installer with SHA256-verified mirror download from `dl.ace-presenter.app/libreoffice/26.2.3/`. ~280 MB per arch. Approve once; future

imports use the bundled install.

Migrating from ProPresenter *(v1.6)*

If you're switching from ProPresenter, the dedicated **ProPresenter Migrator** brings your library across in one click. The onboarding wizard auto-prompts it on first launch when it detects a PP install; you can also reach it any time via **Settings → Import → "Import from ProPresenter"**.

Five-stage wizard:

Stage	What happens
Detect	Looks for ProPresenter 6 + 7 installs. Reads default + custom library paths from PP's plist; you can also point it at a path manually.
Preview	Scans the library and shows exactly what will come over: song count, media-file count, total size. Nothing is imported yet.
Running	Imports songs (with section structure preserved), media (deduped by SHA-256 — no double copies), and playlists.
Done	Summary with one-click **Undo this import** — every record is tagged with an `import_session_id`, so a single click rolls back the entire run.
Error	Surfaces the exact failure (path missing, parse error) with a Retry button.

What's preserved

- Songs from `.pro7` and `.pro` (newer PP7+ filename) protobuf files
- Lyrics extracted from RTF blobs with multi-pass cleanup (preamble groups, residue lines, font-table noise) and de-duplicated by substring containment so the same slide doesn't appear three times under different protobuf nesting levels
- Section structure (Verse, Chorus, Bridge, etc.) — one section per ProPresenter slide
- Media files (images, videos), SHA-256 deduped against your existing Media Bin
- Playlists, with their original ordering

Storage mode

By default, media files are **symlinked** from your ProPresenter library path (no disk-space cost; the file lives where PP put it). If you'd rather copy them so the import is self-contained, choose **Copy** in Preview before running.

Coming in v1.7

Themes / looks mapping — your ACE themes currently apply to imported songs; v1.7 will read PP's slide styling and map it.

---

4. Themes and Looks

ACE separates **how things look** (theme — fonts, colors, background) from **what's enabled** (look — which layers render, which themes apply per screen).

Themes (Theme tab)

A theme defines: font family / size / weight / color, subtitle color, background mode (solid / gradient / image), text shadow, position, margins, line-reveal speed.

- Click **Theme** in the toolbar.
- The grid view shows your themes. **Click a tile** to open the rich editor. Hover ▶ to apply a theme to PROGRAM without editing. Hover ✕ to delete.
- **+ New Theme** creates a custom one from a default template.
- Save → the theme persists in your library and can be applied or referenced by Looks.

Looks (Looks tab) — *headline v1.4 feature*

A Look is a **named configuration** of: - Which layers render (`slide` , `media` , `messages` , `announcements` , `bible` , `props`) - Which theme each output uses (`theme_overrides[screenId] = themeId`) - Per-screen layer overrides (one screen shows media, another doesn't) - Transition duration

Click **Looks** in the toolbar (between Theme and Stage). Per-Look grid:

```
                    Default   Audience-1   Audience-2   Stage
Slide               ✓         ✓            ✓            (auto: parent)
Media               ✓         ✓            (off)        ✓
Bible               ✓         ✓            ✓            (off)
Announcements       ✓         ✓            ✓            (off)
Theme override      —         Dark         Scripture    Default
```

Click **Make Live** to activate the Look. PROGRAM repaints within ~1 second.

Unified render pipeline (the v1.4 opt-in)

Settings → Screens & Display → Advanced → **Unified render pipeline** toggle (default off during burn-in).

When ON: the active Look drives every output. Edit a Look → audience repaints in real time. Per-screen overrides take effect.

When OFF: v1.3-style global theme behaviour. Looks store data but don't drive output.

After one full successful service with the flag on, leave it on. v2 flips the default.

---

5. Outputs (Screen Configuration)

⌘⇧S opens Screen Configuration — the **single source of truth** for outputs (replaces the v1.0–v1.2 dashboard NDI/Audience/Stage toggles).

Audience vs Stage

- **Audience** = what your congregation sees. Lyrics, backgrounds, scripture. Edge-to-edge.
- **Stage** = what the worship team / preacher sees. Confidence layout (current/next slide, timer, clock, sermon notes). Operator-aware chrome.

Multi-display

Both roles support multiple displays. 7 audience screens + 3 stage screens at once if your rig has the displays. Each role's toggle drives all assigned displays in lockstep.

Display Mode toggle (per output)

- **Borderless Fill** *(default)* — preserves your operator menu bar, multi-display friendly. Used by most rigs.
- **True Fullscreen** — own Mission Control Space, smoother for single-output venues. Has its own Space; swipe with 4-finger trackpad.

State badges (per row in modal)

- **Unassigned** — placeholder, no display picked
- **Assigned** — output picked but role toggle is off (window not open)
- **Live** — role toggle on, window painting on the assigned display
- **Identifying** — transient (~3.5s) when you click Identify
- **Test Pattern** — transient (~8s) when running Color Bars / Focus / Greyscale / Solid

Screens menu (macOS menu bar)

- **Configure Screens** (⌘⇧S)
- **Identify All Displays** — pops `DISPLAY N` overlays on every connected display
- **Test Pattern** submenu — Color Bars / Focus / Greyscale / Solid
- **Clear All Overlays** (Esc)

---

6. Detection (lyric + Bible)

ACE uses local Whisper (CoreML on Apple Silicon, ~200 ms latency) to transcribe. Then matches transcripts to your imported library via FAISS vector search.

Modes

- **Auto** — detects either lyrics or Bible references; switches contextually.
- **Song** — locks to lyric matching (best during worship sets).
- **Bible** — locks to scripture references (best during sermon).

Sermon recording

Bottom-right **Sermon Notes** panel:

1. Optional: title + speaker

2. **Start Recording** — backend captures full transcript + extracts key points + auto-detects Bible references
3. **Stop Recording** — Export button appears. Export = full transcript + key points + scripture, with the live-transcript snippet that triggered each scripture match shown beneath the canonical verse (e.g. *"↳ heard: 'God works all things for good'"* under Romans 8:28)
4. Past sermons listed under Settings → Data → Sermon History (export anytime)

Smart Bible auto-advance *(v1.5.3)*

When a Bible verse is currently displayed, ACE listens for the next verse's text in the live transcript. If the preacher reads verse N+1 directly without saying "next verse," ACE auto-advances when the cosine-similarity match against verse N+1's text crosses ≥0.70. This solves the gap where verbal-cue detection ("turn to") didn't fire and the screen sat on verse N while the preacher was already on N+1.

Detection Reset *(v1.5.3)*

⌘⇧R clears stuck vote accumulators, transcript history, and rebuilds the Whisper context-prompt — without stopping audio capture. Replaces the prior workaround of "navigate between Settings tabs to clear state."

Bible verse lock — ⌘⇧L *(v1.5.5)*

When ACE catches the right verse but keeps swapping it for AI alternatives as the preacher continues, press **⌘⇧L** to lock the current verse. While locked:

- The verse on screen stays put
- AI matches still appear in the transcript feed as suggestions
- Nothing auto-pushes to PROGRAM
- Manual **PageDown** / **PageUp** still advance / retreat freely

Press **⌘⇧L** again to unlock. Backend exposes `/api/bible/lock`, `/unlock`, `/lock/toggle` (POST) and `/lock` (GET) for UI integrations.

What v1.4 fixed

- **Section-stuck bug** — detection used to lock onto verse 1 / chorus and refuse to advance even when the band moved on. Whisper context-prompt was self-reinforcing. v1.4 rebalances every section equally; transitions flow with the band.
- **Live transcript not following** — same root cause as section-stuck. Fixed by the same change.
- **Slide-doesn't-reach-HDMI** *(v1.4.1 patch)* — imported slide images now actually paint on audience output, gated on the active Look's `media` layer.

7. Stage Layouts

The operator confidence monitor is fully designable.

Stage tab in the toolbar. Pick a preset (`current-next` , `current-notes` , `current-timers` , `system-clock` , `blank`) or **+ New Layout**.

Each object: - **Type**: `text` (static label), `linked_text` (live source), shape (`box`), `image` , `media_placeholder` - **Source** (for linked_text): `current_slide` , `next_slide` , `system_clock` , `timer` , `presentation_name` , `stage_message` , `video_countdown` - **Position / size**: drag on canvas (1920×1080 logical) - **Style** *(v1.4 Inspector dropdown)*: pick a semantic token (`stage.text.primary` , `stage.text.secondary` , `stage.text.next` , `stage.text.timer` , `stage.text.clock` , `stage.text.muted`) or **Custom hex**

When a token is picked, the active theme drives the rendered color. Custom hex overrides per-object.

Mirror Program toggle *(v1.5.3)*

Each stage layout now has a **Mirror Program** checkbox in the editor topbar. When on, the stage screen mirrors whatever is on the audience output (slide image, scripture, song background, video) as a full-bleed backdrop, with the layout's text objects (current/next lyric, clock, timer, stage message) rendered on top. Speakers see exactly what the audience sees + their confidence cues without turning around.

The mirror reads from the global display theme (`display_*`) so it always tracks the live audience output, regardless of any per-screen Look override the stage might have.

8. Service Plan

Service Plan tab in the toolbar. Drag songs, scripture, prayer items, announcements, sermon, media into a vertical timeline. **Go On Air** advances through items.

- **Adding the first item** *(v1.5.5)* — on a fresh install with no service plan, click **+ Add Item** and ACE auto-creates "Untitled Service" dated today, then attaches your chosen item to it. Plan name + date stay editable inline.
- The standalone **+ New** button was removed in v1.5.6 — the auto-create path above is now the canonical way to start a plan.
- Planning Center Online sync available if PCO is configured (via direct URL `/settings?tab=integrations` for power users; future v2 surfaces this in main UI)

- Each item: assigned theme, layer config, timer, auto-advance rules

---

9. Quick Screens (⌘J)

Floating panel — bottom-right of the dashboard. Type a message, pick a theme, push to PROGRAM in one click.

- **⌘J** — toggle open/closed (skipped while focused inside an input/textarea so you can still type "j")
- **⌘↵ (Cmd+Return)** — display
- Last 10 entries kept on the **Recent** shelf for one-click reuse
- Use cases: announcements, prayer calls, offering reminders, lower-thirds

---

10. Settings highlights

⌘, (Cmd+comma) or click ⚙ in the toolbar.

Sidebar groups:

- **General** — App, Updates, Audio, Network, **CCLI** (your church license number — shown on slide footers), **Display Hold** (how long matches stay on screen)
- **Detection** — AI pipeline, Bible parser, Voice Control
- **Output** — Screens & Display *(includes the "Unified render pipeline" advanced toggle)*, NDI, MIDI. *(ProPresenter + ATEM external-output sub-tabs were hidden in v1.5.7 ahead of the v1.6 ProPresenter Migrator. Source preserved; reach via* `/settings?tab=propresenter` *or* `/settings?tab=atem` *if you still need the OSC-bridge / switcher integrations.)*
- **Data** — Song Index, Import (now includes "Import from ProPresenter" *(v1.6)*), PowerPoint rendering

> **Integrations panel hidden as of v1.4.1.** ACE handles core features (lyric detection, Bible parsing, theme rendering, imports) without operator-supplied API keys. Power users / support reach the integrations panel via direct URL `/settings?tab=integrations`. v2.0 will introduce a license gateway that proxies free-tier services and gates paid-tier ones behind subscription — no keys, ever.

---

11. Keyboard shortcuts (full reference)

The canonical shortcut catalog lives in `src/lib/shortcuts.ts` — this section mirrors it. The shortcut engine **already supports per-shortcut customization** via `localStorage` key `ws-shortcuts-v1` (functions: `saveCustomBinding`, `resetCustomBinding`, `resetAllBindings`, `getEffectiveBindings`). The in-app rebinding UI is queued for v1.5.4 — until then, custom bindings need to be set programmatically via the browser DevTools console, e.g.:

```
// Rebind "Reset Detection" from ⌘⇧R to ⌘⇧Y
const cur = JSON.parse(localStorage.getItem("ws-shortcuts-v1") || "{}");
cur["detection-reset"] = { key: "y", meta: true, shift: true };
localStorage.setItem("ws-shortcuts-v1", JSON.stringify(cur));
window.dispatchEvent(new CustomEvent("ws-shortcuts-updated"));
```

To restore one shortcut to default: delete the key. To reset every shortcut: `localStorage.removeItem("ws-shortcuts-v1")`.

Clear layers

Shortcut	Action
F1	Clear all layers
F2	Clear slide / text
F3	Clear media (background)
F4	Clear props (foreground overlay)
F5	Clear audio
F6	Logo / black toggle
Esc	Clear display (everything)

Slide playback

Shortcut	Action
Space	Take selected slide to Program (live)
P	Send selected slide to Preview
G	Go Live (alternate, ProPresenter style)
→	Next slide
←	Previous slide
Home	First slide
End	Last slide
Tab	Next slide (alternate)
⇧Tab	Previous slide (alternate)
PageUp	Previous Bible verse
PageDown	Next Bible verse

Screen outputs

Shortcut	Action
⌘1	Toggle audience output
⌘2	Toggle stage output
⌘⇧S	Open Screen Configuration

Navigation

Shortcut	Action
⌘K	Command Palette (quick search / action launcher)
⌘L	Library (sidebar)
^B	Bible mode
⌘,	Settings
⌘F	Manual lyric search
⌘I	Import wizard
⌘J	Toggle Quick Screens

Toolbar modes

Shortcut	Action
⌘E	Edit mode
⌘T	Text format mode
⌘⇧M	Media browser

Detection

Shortcut	Action
⌘⇧D	Toggle detection (start / stop)
⌘⇧R	Reset Detection — clear stuck votes / hallucinations *(v1.5.3)*
⌘⇧L	Toggle Bible verse lock — keep current verse on screen, suppress AI auto-pushes *(v1.5.5)*
PageDown	Bible — next verse *(v1.5.3, global)*
PageUp	Bible — previous verse *(v1.5.3, global)*

macOS menu (always works)

Shortcut	Action
⌘,	Preferences (Settings)
⌘D	Start detection (from Detection menu)
⌘⇧D	Stop detection
⌘Q	Quit ACE
⌘W	Close window
⌘M	Minimize
⌘H	Hide ACE

Quick Screens (when panel is open)

Shortcut	Action
⌘↵	Display the typed message
Esc	Close the panel

12. Common workflows

Sunday-morning worship service

1. Open ACE 30 min before service.
2. **Service Plan** tab → drag today's songs in order (or sync from Planning Center).
3. **⌘⇧S** → confirm Audience + Stage toggles are on, displays assigned, both Live.
4. Pick the active **Look** that matches the service mood (e.g. "Standard" / "Worship" / "Scripture").
5. **Start** detection. Walk to the booth, hand over to operator.
6. During worship: ACE auto-advances through detected songs. Operator presses **F1** between songs to clear the screen, or just lets the Display Hold expire.
7. Sermon: switch to **Bible** mode (^B) or stay on Auto. **Sermon Notes** start recording; scripture detected and pushed automatically.
8. After service: stop detection, **Export Last Sermon** for archiving.

Mid-week conference / lecture

1. **Import** the speaker's deck (PPTX / Keynote / PDF) via the wizard.
2. Bible references in slide titles + notes are auto-tagged.
3. During the talk: slides advance automatically as the speaker progresses. **→** for manual override.

Theater / live show

1. Pre-load cue order in **Service Plan**.
2. Use **Quick Screens (⌘J)** for ad-hoc announcements between scenes.
3. Lower-third overlays via **props** layer (foreground media in Media Bin).

13. Troubleshooting

"I imported a Bible but it doesn't appear in the panel / I can't pick it" *(fixed in v1.6.1)*

Through v1.6.0, the BiblePanel translation dropdown + Settings → Bibles → Translations rendered **only** the 5 bundled translation codes (KJV / ASV / BBE / WEB / RV1960). Any user-imported Bible (Zefania / OSIS / OpenSong / MyBible XML) was written to the database correctly + indexed for detection, but had nowhere

to surface in the UI — so the operator never saw the import succeed in the panel they actually live-driver from.

v1.6.1 makes both surfaces render from the actual loaded set (`/api/bible/translations`), falling back to the code itself for unknown identifiers. Settings adds a “Custom” group for codes outside the predefined registry. The Bible panel auto-selects the first loaded translation when KJV isn’t present.

If you’re stuck on v1.6.0 and need the workaround for tonight, you can force the panel via DevTools (View → Developer → Toggle Developer Tools), Console tab:

```
const sel = document.querySelector('select[title="Translation"]');
sel.value = "AMP_2001";  // or your imported code — see GET /api/bible/translations
sel.dispatchEvent(new Event('change', { bubbles: true }));
```

“I’m on an Intel Mac and ACE never opened / showed a blank window” *(fixed in v1.6.0)*

Every Intel ACE DMG from v1.0 through v1.5.7 silently shipped with the wrong helper binary inside — Intel installs got an Apple-Silicon backend, and the visible app launched but couldn’t actually transcribe / detect / display. **v1.6.0** ships per-architecture helpers (the Intel build now contains the Intel backend, the Apple-Silicon build contains the arm64 backend). If you tried earlier and gave up, grab v1.6.0 fresh from the download button — the install is otherwise the same. See the Intel notice page for the longer explanation.

“App vanished from the dock when the audience window opened” *(fixed in v1.5.7)*

Single-display Macs only. The audience + stage windows used a window level that outranked macOS’s dock and menu-bar, which on a multi-display rig is correct (audience is on a separate display) but on a single-display rig pushed the operator’s own dock visually out. v1.5.7 detects display count: single-display rigs use a lower window level so the dock stays visible.

“Settings buttons during onboarding (mic / screen recording) did nothing” *(fixed in v1.5.5)*

The onboarding wizard’s “Open Settings” buttons jump you to the right pane in macOS System Settings via `x-apple.systempreferences:` deep-links. v1.4 onwards, the IPC handler only allowed `http(s)://` URLs and rejected those deep-links silently. v1.5.5 extends the allowlist to `x-apple.systempreferences:` + `mailto:` .

“F2 / Clear Slide left the slide image stuck on the audience screen” *(fixed in v1.5.4)*

The keyboard shortcut + the `/api/display/clear/{layer}` endpoint cleared the lyric overlay but never wiped the slide image — so audience output stayed showing the last slide while subsequent pushes appeared “stuck.” v1.5.4 makes every clear path that targets the slide layer also wipe

`display_bg_image_path`. Right-panel "Clear" worked already because it restored a frontend snapshot; the keyboard / API path now matches.

"+ New button on the Service Plan does nothing" *(removed in v1.5.6)*

The button used a native `window.prompt()` which Electron disables since v19, so the click silently no-op'd. As of v1.5.6 the button is gone — instead, hit **+ Add Item** on a fresh service plan and ACE auto-creates "Untitled Service" dated today *(v1.5.5)*. Plan name + date stay editable inline.

"Mic level low" (visualizer is amber)

- Check the input device in Settings → General → Audio
- If using an external interface: confirm the interface routes the worship-room mic to ACE's input
- Move closer to the mic source if possible

"Detection isn't picking my song"

- First check it's imported: Settings → Data → Song Index
- Try Manual Search (**⌘F**) — confirms FAISS has the lyrics indexed
- If your song is genuinely obscure, ACE falls back to ACR audio fingerprinting (if you've configured an ACR key — power user)

"Slide doesn't reach the audience output"

- Confirm Audience output is **Live** (green badge in ⌘⇧S)
- If active Look has `media` layer disabled per-screen, slides hide. Check Looks panel.

"Stage output shows wrong layout"

- **Stage** tab → confirm the right preset is active
- Or `/api/stage/layouts/active` returns the wrong id — check Settings → Output → Stage

"Tour isn't showing again"

- Settings → General → "Show tour again" (re-triggers `useTourState`)

"Update prompt says I'm on v1.2.1 but I just installed v1.4"

- Fixed in v1.4.0 build pipeline. If you still see this: confirm you replaced `/Applications/ACE.app` (drag-and-drop the new DMG, accept the replace prompt). The first-launch read of `_VERSION.txt`

from the bundle should report 1.4.x.

“Detection got stuck on verse 1 / chorus and won’t advance”

- This was the v1.3 bug fixed in v1.4. Confirm Settings → Updates shows v1.4 or later. If yes and it still happens: please report.

“Detection is hallucinating / pushing the wrong verse”

- Press **⌘⇧R** to clear stuck votes + transcript history + rebuild the Whisper context-prompt without stopping audio capture. *(v1.5.3)*
- If it persists: switch detection mode (Auto/Song/Bible) — the mode-switch handler runs the same reset automatically.

“PPTX imports as just text on a black background, no slide design”

- LibreOffice headless conversion failed. Most common causes: profile lock (another LO instance open), missing JRE, or sandbox permission denial.
- v1.5.3 isolates each import to its own profile dir + adds `--nolockcheck`, killing the most common case. If it still happens, the backend log now prints the captured `stdout` / `stderr` from `soffice` — paste that to support.

“Mirror Program toggle saved but stage screen didn’t change”

- Fixed in v1.5.3. If you’re on v1.5.2 or earlier, the workaround is: switch to the Blank layout, save, switch back, save. v1.5.3 makes Mirror apply on the first save.

“Old slide keeps showing after I deleted the PPTX”

- Fixed in v1.5.3 — delete now clears `display_bg_image_path` if it was pointing at one of the removed slides, plus the audience window cache-busts on path change. If you’re on an earlier version: **F2** (Clear Slide) or **⌘⇧B** (Black) clears the stuck image manually.

“Imported the same-named PPTX twice and the audience screen shows the old version”

- Fixed in v1.5.3 (per-path cache-bust on slide URL). On earlier versions: hard-reload the audience window (Cmd-Shift-R inside the audience BrowserWindow if accessible) or restart the app.

---

14. Where things live

Thing	Location
Operator config	`~/Library/Application Support/ACE/user_config.json`
Imported songs / presentations / Bibles (DB)	`~/Library/Application Support/ACE/data.db`
Imported slide images	`~/Library/Application Support/ACE/presentations/`
Bundled background images	inside the `.app`, copied to user data on first launch
LibreOffice (when installed via deferred-install)	`~/Library/Application Support/ACE/libreoffice/`
Backend logs	`~/Library/Logs/ACE-backend.log`
Electron main logs	`~/Library/Logs/ACE-main.log`

To reset ACE entirely: quit the app, delete `~/Library/Application Support/ACE/`, relaunch. First-run wizard fires again.

15. Getting help

- **In-app tour** — Settings → General → "Show tour again"
- **Releases & changelog** — Settings → General → Updates shows the running version's release notes; full history at `CHANGELOG.md` at the repo root
- **Marketing site** — https://ace-presenter.app
- **Email support** — hello@ace-presenter.app

16. Glossary

- **Look** — a named bundle of theme + layer toggles + per-screen overrides + transition. The v1.4 unified-render headline.
- **Theme** — typography + colors + background style (gradient / solid / image). Standalone, can be referenced by Looks.
- **Layer** — one of `slide` (lyrics), `media` (background), `messages` (audience-bottom strip), `announcements` (banner), `props` (foreground overlay), `bible` (scripture).
- **Screen** vs **Output** — Screen = what ACE renders (logical). Output = where it goes (HDMI / NDI / SDI). v2 splits these formally; v1.4 still treats them together.
- **PROGRAM** — what's currently live on the audience output.
- **PREVIEW** — what's queued to go live next (operator stages it, then takes it).
- **Service Plan** — the day's order of items (songs, scripture, prayer, announcements, sermon).
- **Look · Make Live** — the action that activates a Look as the current rendering configuration. PROGRAM repaints within ~1 second.
- **Borderless Fill** vs **True Fullscreen** — Borderless fills the display without taking a Mission Control Space; True Fullscreen gets its own Space (swipe between desktops to reach the operator UI).

---

17. Feature Index — every panel, every button

This section enumerates every distinct surface in the app. Use it as a reference / discovery aid; the workflow narrative is in earlier sections.

Toolbar (top of dashboard)

Control	Function
Start / Stop	Toggles detection. Audio capture, Whisper, FAISS — all on.
Audio visualizer	Mic-level traffic light (amber too quiet / green good / red peaking). Click to open Audio settings.
Auto / Song / Bible	Detection mode picker. Mode change clears vote state + rebuilds Whisper context-prompt automatically *(v1.5.3)*.
Live / Hold	When Live, detected matches push to Program. When Hold, detection runs but doesn't push (useful between songs).
Confidence ±	Live-tweak the AI threshold. Higher = stricter, lower = more permissive.
Show / Edit / Bible / Theme / Looks / Stage / Service Plan	Workflow mode tabs (center). Switch between live operating, lyric editing, scripture browsing, theme designer, Look manager, stage layout designer, and service plan editor.
Import *(⌘I)*	Unified wizard for songs / Bibles / slides / audio.
⚙ **Settings** *(⌘,)*	Open settings.

Sidebar (left)

- **Library tabs** — Songs / Presentations / Bibles
- **Sub-filters** — recently used, by source, by language
- **Drag-reorder** — sets the current Service Plan order
- **Add via +** — opens AddSongModal (Genius / paste lyrics / search)
- **Drag-drop** — accepts files, routes through Import wizard

Center column (depends on tab)

Mode	Surface
Show	Current + Next song sections (slide cards), live transcript, scripture display, slide grid for selected presentation
Edit	ReflowEditor — slide-grid section editor *(v1.5.3 redesign)*, configurable 1–6 columns, click card to expand into full edit, Esc collapses, drag handle reorders spatially
Bible	BiblePanel — verse browser + context view + auto-display
Theme	Grid of saved themes; click tile → rich theme designer (typography, colors, gradients, shadows, position, margins, line-reveal speed)
Looks	Per-Look grid showing layer toggles + per-screen theme overrides + transition duration. **Make Live** activates a Look.
Stage	StageLayoutEditor — canvas (1920×1080), object placement, semantic-token styling, **Mirror Program** toggle *(v1.5.3)*, layout preset switcher
Service Plan	ServiceBuilder — vertical timeline of items (songs / scripture / prayer / sermon / announcements / media), drag-reorder, Go-On-Air

Right panel

- **Preview / Program** tabs — what's queued (Preview) and what's live (Program). Click PVW or PGM buttons on song-section / slide cards to send.
- **Macros** — operator-fired automation buttons (clear all, switch look, blank).
- **Sermon Notes** — bottom-right. Title, speaker, Start/Stop Recording. Auto-detects scripture during sermons + extracts key points. Export full transcript + scripture-context-anchored notes.

Media Bin (bottom dock)

- **Playlists** — saved sets of media (e.g., “Christmas backgrounds”)
- **Asset library** — all imported videos / images, filterable
- **Stock Bin filter** — Pixabay search (if configured)
- **Per-asset fit mode** — fit / fill / stretch
- **Drag onto preview** — sets as audience background

Audience window (`/stage?role=program`)

- Renders Program theme + slide / scripture / lyrics overlays
- Reads `display_bg_*` settings from backend
- Cold-start clears stale `bg_image_path` *(v1.5.3)*
- Slide URL cache-busts on path change *(v1.5.3)*
- Slide aspect: `objectFit: "cover"` (full-bleed) *(v1.5.3)*

Stage window (`/stage?role=stage`)

- Renders the active stage layout’s objects
- Honours per-screen Look theme override
- **Mirror Program** *(v1.5.3)* — when on, full-bleed audience backdrop with stage cues on top

Multi-view (`/multiview`)

- Live preview of every output in one window — useful for the booth / iPad on a stand
- Read-only; no operator controls

Quick Screens panel *(⌘J)*

- Floating bottom-right panel
- Type a message, pick a theme, push to Program
- 10 most recent on the Recent shelf
- Use cases: announcements, prayer call, offering, lower-thirds

Command Palette *(⌘K)*

- ⌘K opens fuzzy-search action launcher
- Search by song / scripture / panel / setting / shortcut
- Acts as the universal “do anything” affordance

In-app tour

- Runs once after first launch (5-step quick walk)
- Settings → General → “Show tour again” re-triggers
- Currently doesn’t cover v1.2+ features — pair with this guide

Animated welcome splash *(v1.6)*

- First-launch brand intro before the onboarding wizard
- Concentric pulsing rings around the ACE logo at the bullseye (logo counter-rotates so it stays upright while the rings spin), drifting blurred orbs, italic-serif tagline slide-up, hairline shimmer bar
- Click anywhere or wait ~15 seconds to dismiss
- Honours `prefers-reduced-motion` — vestibular-sensitive users get the brand moment without the movement
- Transitions cleanly into the regular onboarding wizard

Onboarding wizard *(v1.4.2+)*

- 5-step modal: Welcome → Backend → Model → Permissions → Done
- Auto-fires Whisper model download in background
- Mic-permission request gated to one prompt
- Skip-bypass safe — dashboard mounts `ModelDownloadBanner` as fallback *(v1.5.2)*
- “Re-run setup wizard” available in Settings → Audio → Recovery *(v1.5.2)*
- **Auto-prompts the ProPresenter Migrator** *(v1.6)* on first launch when a ProPresenter install is detected on the user’s Mac

ProPresenter Migrator *(v1.6)*

- 5-stage wizard: Detect → Preview → Running → Done → Error
- Reachable from **Settings → Import → “Import from ProPresenter”** any time, or auto-prompted from the onboarding wizard on first launch
- Detects PP6 / PP7 installs (default + custom library paths via plist)
- Preview shows song + media counts before importing
- Symlink (default, no disk-space cost) or Copy (self-contained) mode
- Every record tagged with `import_session_id` → one-click **Undo this import**
- Songs from `.pro7` and `.pro` (newer PP7+ filename); media SHA-256 deduped against existing Media Bin
- Section structure preserved (one ACE section per ProPresenter slide)

- Playlists imported with original ordering

---

18. Complete Settings Reference

`⌘,` to open. Sidebar groups every setting under a high-level category.

General

- **App** — app name, theme (light/dark — currently dark only), language
- **Updates** — running version, latest release, update notes
- **Audio** — input device, sample rate, gain, **Recovery** (Re-download speech model, Re-run setup wizard) *(v1.5.2)*
- **Network** — backend port, allowed origins, CORS
- **CCLI** — your church CCLI license number; renders on slide footer for legal compliance
- **Display Hold** — `display_hold_strong` (how long a strong-confidence match stays on screen), `display_hold_weak` (weak match)
- **Tour** — re-trigger the in-app tour

Detection

- **Detection mode** — Auto / Song-only / Bible-only (also on toolbar)
- **Confidence threshold** — global AI confidence floor
- **Bible parser** — strict / lenient match modes; verse-context window (verses before/after)
- **Voice control** — voice-command toggle (e.g. "ACE next slide")
- **Whisper model** — tiny / base / small / medium / large-v3 (memory ↔ accuracy trade-off)
- **Transcription language** — Auto-detect (bilingual) / English / Spanish / Portuguese / etc.
- **Online transcription** — Deepgram on/off (requires API key)
- **Auto-display Bible** — toggle whether bible_detection auto-pushes to Program
- **Bible auto-display floor** — confidence ≥ 0.60 threshold *(v1.5.3, was 0.55)*

Output

- **Screens & Display** — `⌘⇧S` Configure Screens; per-output assignment, role (audience/stage/multi-view), display mode (Borderless Fill / True Fullscreen)
- **Theme background** — bg_mode (solid/gradient/image), bg_color, bg_gradient_*, bg_image_path, bg_image_opacity

- **Theme typography** — font_family, font_size, font_weight, font_color, subtitle_color, position, h_margin, v_margin, line_reveal, reveal_speed, visible_lines, text_shadow + shadow color/offset
- **Unified render pipeline** *(v1.4 advanced toggle)* — opt-in flag for Look-driven rendering
- **NDI** — NDI output toggle, source name, channel
- **MIDI** — incoming MIDI shortcut bindings (note-on / CC mappings)

> **External-output integrations hidden as of v1.5.7** — ProPresenter (OSC bridge) and ATEM (Blackmagic switcher control) sub-tabs were removed from Settings → Output ahead of the v1.6 ProPresenter Migrator. The migration story is "ACE replaces PP" rather than "ACE talks to PP." Source code is intact; reach the panels via direct URL `/settings?tab=propresenter` or `/settings?tab=atem` if you still need them. Single backend flag `EXTERNAL_OUTPUT_INTEGRATIONS_ENABLED` re-enables the UI.

Data

- **Song Index** — re-index all songs, drop & rebuild FAISS, view index size
- **Import** — default conflict-resolution mode, default theme for imports, **"Import from ProPresenter"** button *(v1.6 — opens the migrator wizard)*
- **PowerPoint rendering** — DPI (default 150), rendering backend (LibreOffice headless)
- **LibreOffice deferred-install** — install / re-install / status

Integrations *(hidden by default; reach via /settings?tab=integrations)*

- **ACRCloud** — audio-fingerprint fallback identification (key/secret/host)
- **Anthropic** — sermon key-point extraction (Claude API key)
- **Deepgram** — online transcription (API key)
- **Genius** — lyric fetch (access token)
- **Pixabay** — stock-media search (API key)
- **Planning Center Online** — service plan sync (OAuth)
- **Apple Developer signing** *(build-machine only, never bundled)*

---

19. API Endpoints (selected — for power users)

Backend runs on `http://127.0.0.1:8765` by default. Full list in `docs/API.md`. Highlights:

Endpoint	Purpose
`POST /api/detection/start`	Begin detection
`POST /api/detection/stop`	Stop detection
`POST /api/detection/reset` *(v1.5.3)*	Clear stuck votes + transcripts + rebuild Whisper prompt
`POST /api/detection/reidentify`	Force ACR + Genius re-identify of currently-playing audio
`POST /api/bible/advance` *(v1.5.3)*	Advance currently-displayed verse to N+1
`POST /api/bible/retreat` *(v1.5.3)*	Retreat currently-displayed verse to N-1
`GET /api/bible/lock` *(v1.5.5)*	Read current verse-lock state
`POST /api/bible/lock` / `/unlock` / `/lock/toggle` *(v1.5.5)*	Verse-lock control
`POST /api/propresenter-migrator/detect` *(v1.6)*	Probe for PP install + return library paths
`POST /api/propresenter-migrator/scan` *(v1.6)*	Preview import — returns song / media counts
`POST /api/propresenter-migrator/import` *(v1.6)*	Run the import (modes: `symlink` / `copy`); returns `import_session_id`
`POST /api/propresenter-migrator/rollback/{session_id}` *(v1.6)*	One-click undo of an import session
`POST /api/display/clear`	Clear lyrics overlay
`POST /api/display/black`	Full blackout (clears lyrics + media bg)
`POST /api/display/release`	Release operator hold
`POST /api/slides/import`	Import a PPTX/PDF/Keynote
`GET /api/slides/{presentation_id}`	List slides for a presentation

Endpoint	Purpose
`DELETE /api/slides/{presentation_id}`	Remove a presentation + its slide files; clears `display_bg_image_path` if it pointed at one of the removed slides *(v1.5.3)*
`GET /api/media/file/{filename}`	Serve a media file; v1.5.3 also searches `slides/<batch>/`
`PUT /api/settings`	Update any settings; v1.5.3 broadcasts `theme_applied` on display_* changes
`GET /api/looks` / `PUT /api/looks/{id}`	Look CRUD
`GET /api/themes` / `PUT /api/themes/{id}`	Theme CRUD
`GET /api/stage/layouts` / `POST /api/stage/layouts/{id}/live`	Stage layout CRUD
`GET /api/services/active` / `POST /api/services/{id}/go`	Service Plan
`GET /api/sermons` / `POST /api/sermons/start`	Sermon recording

WebSocket events

`ws://127.0.0.1:8765/ws` — broadcast channel. Notable types:

- `detection`, `bible_detection`, `auto_display`
- `display_cleared`, `media_cleared`, `blackout`
- `theme_applied`, `look_changed`, `stage_layout_changed`
- `media_foreground_set`, `media_foreground_cleared`
- `slides_imported`, `libreoffice_install_progress`
- `sermon_note`, `voice_command`
- `bible_lock_changed` *(v1.5.5)*
- `propresenter_migrator_progress` *(v1.6)* — emits per-stage updates (`detecting`, `scanning`, `importing`, `done`, `error`) with item counts

Updated for v1.6.1 (2026-05-10). For changes since: see CHANGELOG.md. For the in-app tour: it's deliberately shorter than this guide — see also project_in_app_tour.md.